# Cold War, China & India: Reading

World History · Unit 9 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with the Cold War terms sheet, communism in China and Mao sheets, and Indian Independence review

Name: _____

## A Divided World After 1945

After World War II, the United States and the Soviet Union became rival superpowers. The U.S. favored capitalism, where private individuals own businesses, and democracy, where people elect leaders. The USSR favored communism, where the government owns the means of production, and a one-party dictatorship. Because the two never fought a full war directly, their rivalry is called the Cold War (1945-1991).

Stalin set up communist governments in Eastern Europe. In 1946 Winston Churchill said an 'iron curtain' had come down across Europe. President Harry Truman adopted containment, a policy of stopping communism from spreading, based on the domino theory. The Marshall Plan gave billions of dollars to rebuild Western Europe. In 1949 the U.S., Canada and Western European nations formed NATO for mutual defense; in 1955 the Soviets answered with the Warsaw Pact. When the Soviets blocked West Berlin in 1948, U.S. and British planes flew in food and fuel for 328 days, the Berlin Airlift. In 1961 the Berlin Wall was built; it fell in 1989.

Fear of communism also shaped life in the U.S. Julius and Ethel Rosenberg were executed in 1953 for passing atomic secrets to the Soviets. Senator Joseph McCarthy and the House Un-American Activities Committee (HUAC) accused many people of disloyalty, and some Hollywood writers were blacklisted and lost their jobs.

In China, Mao Zedong's Communists fought Chiang Kai-shek's Nationalists. The Long March (1934-35) built support for Mao, and during WWII both sides fought Japan. Mao won peasant support with land reform, and in 1949 he founded the People's Republic of China while Chiang fled to Taiwan. Mao's Five-Year Plans and the Great Leap Forward caused famine. In the Cultural Revolution (1966-76), young Red Guards attacked teachers, officials and the 'Four Olds' (old customs, culture, habits and ideas).

India was Britain's 'jewel in the crown.' After the Sepoy Rebellion of 1857, Britain ruled India directly (the Raj). The Indian National Congress worked for self-rule, and Mohandas Gandhi led nonviolent protests such as boycotts and the Salt March. In 1947 India became independent, but it was partitioned into mostly Hindu India, led by Jawaharlal Nehru, and mostly Muslim Pakistan, led by Muhammad Ali Jinnah, who feared Muslims would be a powerless minority. Partition caused mass migration and violence. Nehru's daughter, Indira Gandhi, later served as prime minister.

## Check your reading

1. Compare the goals of capitalism and communism.

2. Why did the communists keep popularity in China after WWII?

3. What did Jinnah believe partition would do for the Muslim minority?